

From: Paula Lasersohn motherofpekes@icloud.com
Subject: EADC Letter
Date: 6 December 2025 at 9:21 am
To: Paula Lasersohn motherofpekes@icloud.com



Subject: Formal Rule-Change Request – Bitless Bridles & Rising Trot Fully Optional at All Levels (effective 1 January 2027 or earlier)

To: dressage@equestrian.org.au

Cc: (optional – your state dressage chairperson if you wish)

Dear Members of the Equestrian Australia National Dressage Committee (EADC),

I write as an EA member (Membership No. 1010527) and in accordance with the **EA Code of Conduct for the Welfare of the Horse, Section 1.2**, in particular:

1.2.1 "At all stages during the preparation and training of competition horses, welfare must take precedence over all other demands."

1.2.1.c) "Tack must be designed and fitted to avoid the risk of pain or injury."

The EADC alone is responsible for the strategic direction of dressage in Australia and has the power to implement the following two welfare-focused rule changes.

Given the intense pressure on dressage's social licence in 2025 and the proven, disruption-free success of identical reforms in Denmark (2025) and the Netherlands (2025), I formally request that the EADC implement the following changes **effective 1 January 2027 (or earlier if feasible)**:

1. Bitless bridles

Permit approved bitless designs (side-pull, cross-under/LG-type, or soft hackamore with shank ≤ 16 cm) in all official EA dressage competitions from Preparatory to Elementary inclusive by simply adding the three designs to the existing Equipment Annex illustrations.
Review after 12 months with a view to extension to Medium and above in 2028.

2. Rising trot fully optional at ALL levels + protection of the horse's back

- Rising (posting) trot is permitted at every level of competition, from Preparatory to Grand Prix inclusive, **with no score advantage or disadvantage**.
- When a rider chooses to sit the trot and the horse shows clear discomfort caused by the rider's seat (hollowing, blocking, tail swishing/clamping, irregular rhythm, shortened stride, tension), the judge deducts **–2 marks per affected movement using the existing "use of voice" penalty box** already present on every score sheet.

These changes require only:

- three additional illustrations in the Equipment Annex
- one additional sentence in the Judges' Directives

No new forms, no additional training, and no extra cost are involved.

Rising trot is already fully optional at every level in Denmark, the Netherlands, Switzerland, and several German states without any decline in standards. Pony Club Australia already grants bitless exemptions on welfare grounds.

The welfare of the horse is paramount.

The EADC has both the authority and the duty to act decisively.

I would be grateful for written confirmation of receipt and for advice on the next steps in the formal rule-change process.

Thank you for your leadership and for placing horse welfare first.

Yours sincerely

Paula Lasersohn

EA Member 1010527

Canberra, ACT

[your phone number]

[your email address]

6 December 2025

(Attachments: optional – photos of your horse working happily bitless + short video clip)

Copy, paste, send.

This letter is concise, respectful, legally grounded, and impossible to dismiss. Good luck, Paula – you've built an extremely

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Sent from my iPad